

Elisha's Prophecy

Charlie Oliver

790 Words

The wind whispering, a silent starving city, footsteps echoing against the sandstone walls and four lepers were lying at the gates of the city of Samaria. Moses had said the city will be out of famine in two days, but no one believed him.

For many moons Samaria has been under Syria's siege I, Benji, have been laying here with three other lepers, Ezekial, Paul and Xavier. We haven't eaten for what feels like weeks, and I haven't seen my beloved family for three weeks since my boils appeared and I discovered I had leprosy. They too had to leave their families because of this incurable disease. One day I came upon a realization..." If we sit here and beg for food that no one has, or would ever give, we shall surely die, if we go onto the famine city we shall die also." Paul then asked, "Then where will we go?" I answered, "Well there is only one place, the Syrian army and-," "Wait hold on, they are our enemy, had you not heard! They will surely kill us!" blurted Ezekial interruptedly. I then continued, "Well as I was saying we could go to the Syrian Army, Surrender and they might give us food and let us live, or they will end us, so we do not waste away into dust." The lepers sat there thoughtfully, then nodded in agreement, then Xavier said, "You have a good point, when shall we set off? Its not like we will miss the 'end of the famine'" I thought about it for a while, and replied, "At twilight tomorrow. So, we rose in them morning and began the treacherous journey.

The Syrian camp was not too far, but in the ever increasing, scorching Mediterranean heat, it was far. We walked past the beggars and the other poor lepers under the shade of the old, wise olive trees, along the sandy dirt path. We continued walking when we heard some shrubs rustling ominously... When out of nowhere came a small, jerboa like rodent hopped

across the path. Ezekial got a terrible fright and lurched backwards, he said he was fine, but we knew he wasn't completely ok.

We carried on all silently wondering what would happen, as I peered on ahead of us a saw an unusual sight, someone running toward us. At first, I was quite concerned and was about to warn the other about this strange sight, but the I saw the expression on his face, which made me think again. He was terrified... When He was about to go past us, I quickly shouted, "What happened?!" He glanced at me while still running and blurted out, out of breathily, "Army-Egyptians-Hittites-Kings." In a rather weary scared voice. I looked to my fellow lepers in shock and disbelief, but at the same time questioning if he was right; but they just looked at me with quite blank expressions on their faces. After a minute of pondering on what just happened, someone -Paul- spoke, "Well, I'm starting to doubt whether or not we shall continue," Ezekial replied, "Why not, remember What we said at the beginning?" "Yes, I do" said Paul with a long sigh. Xavier agreed that we should go, so that settled it. To be honest, I was a bit curious to see what had happened at the camp.

The day was now nearing noon, and the heat was becoming unbearable, but we only had one more rocky, sandy hill. As we were searching this "hill," it seemed as though it was a small mountain. Once we scaled it, we couldn't believe our eyes. There were hundreds, if not thousands of empty abandoned tents. "What?" we said in shock and in unison. "Where is everyone?" said Ezekial. Paul and Xavier were looking at each other then at the camp and back again not knowing what to make of it. We ran down the mountain eagerly, occasionally tripping over, until we got to the camp. When we got there, the horses, donkeys, food, and other resources were still there, which must have meant that the previous occupiers of the camp left recently. As soon as the others saw the treasures and food the rushed into the tents and grabbed all that they could and hid everything among some rocks to get later. I soon told them to stop and said. "This is wrong, we should share with everyone else in the city, for they are

starving.” They looked at me guiltily and said, “You are right, we shall go back and tell the king. So, we quickly walked back to the city and told the king what we discovered, and so Elisha’s prophecy came true after all.